TOGETHER, WE RISE

WITH EXCELLENCE. WITH PURPOSE.

MLC Community Meeting with Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong & Team

February 18, 2026

Kristina Howard, Sr. Chief of Academics

Purpose and Goals

Purpose: to center family and community voices regarding the decision to conclude the 9-12 programming at MLC

Goals:

- **Share** our thinking and the context behind how the decision was made
- **Hear** directly from you about how this decision has impacted you and your community
- **Explore** possible next steps together

Our Timing

6:00 pm - 6:10 pm Welcome and Introductions

6:10 pm - 6:30 pm Deeper dive into the decision and context

6:30 pm - 6:45 pm Next Steps

6:45 pm - 7:45 pm Question & Answer

Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong, Superintendent

When decisions affect students, how they unfold matters.

Community Agreements:

How We'll be Together Tonight

Stay Engaged
We commit to being fully present in this conversation, with curiosity, humility, and openness to learning.

Speak Your Truth
We share from our own experience, using "I" statements rather than speaking for others or entire groups.

Experience Discomfort
We expect and accept that discomfort may arise. Growth requires stretching our comfort zones.

Lean Into Courage, Not Perfection
This is not about saying everything "right," but about showing up with care, honesty, and a willingness to learn.

Listen to Understand, Not to Respond
We listen for understanding, especially when perspectives differ from our own. Listening is an act of respect and community building.

Center the Voices Closest to the Pain
We recognize and prioritize the lived experiences of students, families, and communities most impacted by this conversation.

Honor Intent and Impact
We can mean well and still cause harm. When this happens, we pause, repair, and recommit to the work.

Stay Curious, Not Critical
We approach ideas and people with curiosity, asking "what am I learning?" instead of "what's wrong with this?"

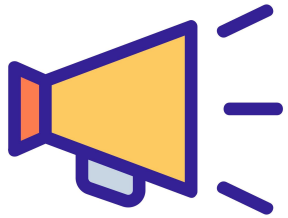
Expect and Accept Non-Closure
This work is ongoing. We won't solve everything tonight, but we can move forward together in understanding and partnership.

Protect the Space
We uphold confidentiality and respect, ensuring this is a space for brave, honest, and compassionate dialogue.

The How : Budget Engagement Plan

What programs and services overlap and which can be combined to maximize programming and supports across PPS?

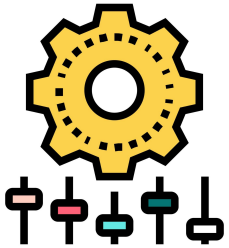
Week of January 12
Targeted Engagement



Week of January 19
Community Engagement



Week of January 26
Synthesis + Decisions



Week of February 2
Staffing Release



Current High School Alternative and Focus Options

In District Alternative School
Alliance High School
Metropolitan Learning Center

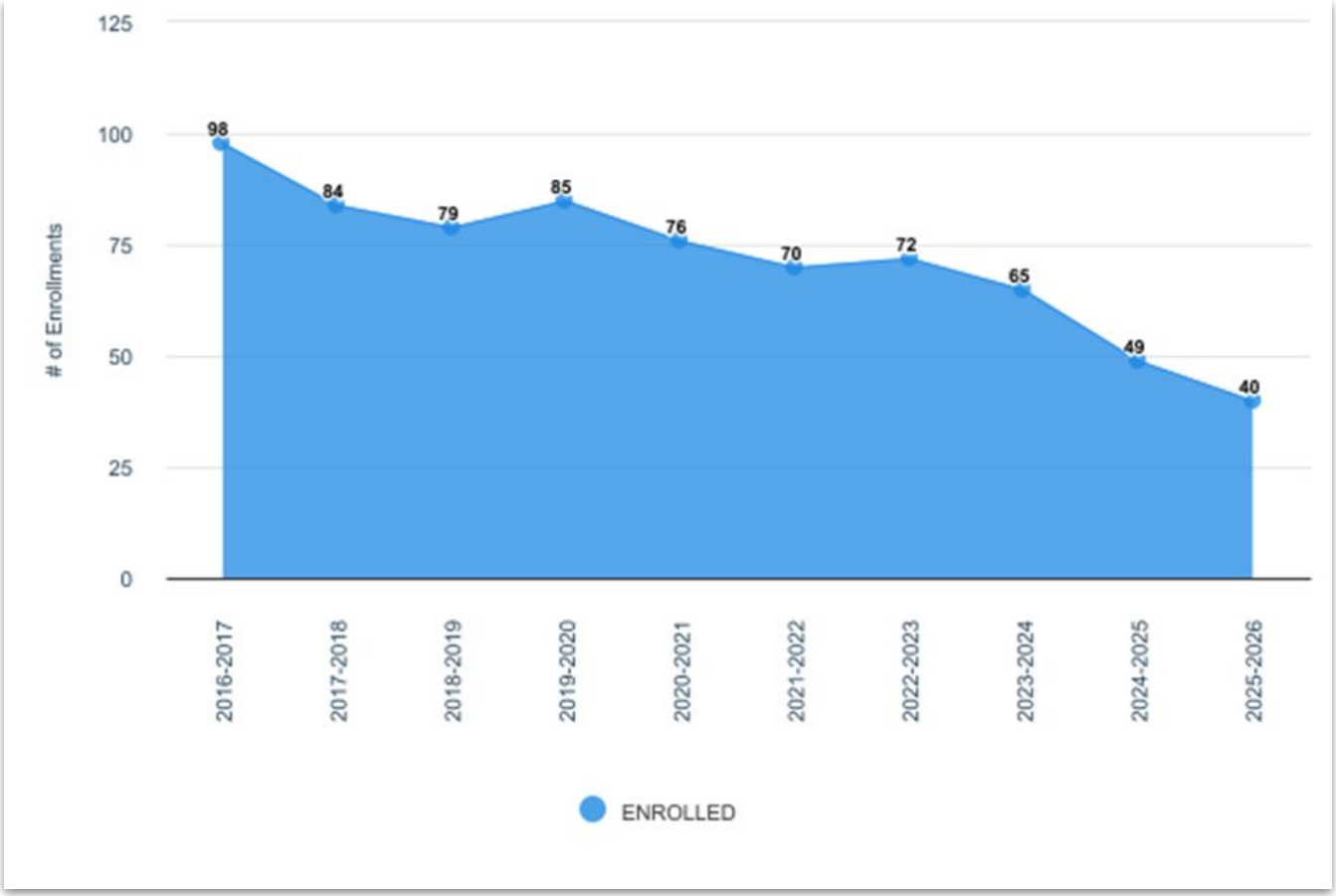
HS Diploma / Traditional HS Programs
Mt. Scott Learning Center
NAYA Many Nations Academy
Rosemary Anderson Prep - Lents
Rosemary Anderson Prep - North
Helensview
Open School

Career and College Focused & GED Options
PCC Yes to College - SE Campus
PCC Yes to College - Cascade Campus
PCC Yes to College - Sylvania Campus
Portland Youth Builders (PYB)

Focus Option High Schools
Jefferson High School
Benson High School

Enrollment

MLC Grades 9-12 Enrollment Over the Last Ten Years



Grade	Students with a Disability	All Students	% Receiving Special Education Services
9-12 Totals	14	40	35.0%

Descriptor	Number	Percent
Enrolled in MLC prior to 9th grade	13	32.5%
Enrolled in MLC in 9th grade or later	27	67.5%
Only High School has been MLC	33	82.5%
More than one High School enrollment	7	17.5%

Context: Our Investments in Alternative Learning

Quality, Stability, Equity of Access

Sustaining the **Quality** of the High School Experience

Over time, enrollment in our alternative learning environment has declined to a level where we are no longer able to consistently provide:

- A broad and responsive range of course options
- Stable staffing and the depth of instructional support students need
- The diverse pathways, wraparound services, and personalized supports that define strong alternative programs

When enrollment falls below a sustainable level, the flexibility, individualized attention, and comprehensive supports that students rely on become increasingly difficult to maintain.

Staffing **Stability** and Instructional Continuity

A strong alternative learning environment depends on:

- Educators who can provide personalized, relationship-centered instruction
- Flexible yet reliable schedules that support individualized pathways
- Consistent staffing that builds trust and continuity for students

When enrollment drops to very small levels, staffing often requires split roles, blended groupings, and complex scheduling structures. Over time, these adjustments can strain the individualized supports and stability that alternative learning environments are designed to provide.

Equity of Access to Opportunity

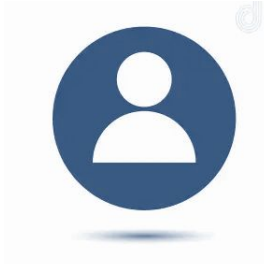
Students in alternative learning environments deserve meaningful academic opportunities, enrichment, and strong peer connections.

At the current scale, it is difficult to provide the same range of experiences available in larger settings.

Dr. Isaac Cardona, Chief of Schools

No two students are alike









26-27 High School Alternative and Focus Options

In District Alternative School
Alliance High School

HS Diploma / Traditional HS Programs*
Mt. Scott Learning Center
NAYA Many Nations Academy
Rosemary Anderson Prep - Lents
Rosemary Anderson Prep - North
Helensview
Open School

Career and College Focused & GED Options
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Benson High School

*Currently in the application renewal process

MLC Student Options Fair

When: Next Tuesday, February 24, from 10:00 am - 11:30 am

Where: MLC Auditorium

Who Will be Present: PPS Multiple Pathways to Graduation Alternative Schools



The Reconnection Services, Enrollment and Transfer, and representatives from PPS's alternative schools will be available on-site to work individually with students.

MLC Student School Tours

Jefferson High School

When: Next Wednesday, February 25, at 2:00 pm

Benson High School

When: Next Thursday, February 26, at 2:45 pm

Alliance High School

When: Next Thursday, February 26, at 2:00 pm

The Reconnection Services Team is ready to support students. Outreach Coordinators will be available to work individually, join the tours, and provide support and information

Questions and Answers

Your Feedback Matters

Thank you for attending tonight's session. Your perspective matters!

Please take a few minutes to share your feedback.

Scan the QR code or go to this link: https://forms.gle/FuQ3Pi9jd3xYuHCE7